

HR USER GUIDE

McLink Recruitment Portal

A complete, step-by-step guide for HR, Hiring Managers (HODs), and Management

Prepared for: McLink Group HR Team

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Audience: HR administrators, Department Heads (HODs), and
Approving Management — no technical background required

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1. Introduction — What is the Recruitment Portal?

The McLink Recruitment Portal is the company's online system for managing the entire hiring process — from a Department Head requesting a new position, through HR review and Management approval, to publishing the job, screening candidates with the help of an AI assistant named **Ella**, and scheduling interviews.

Everything happens in one place: role requests, approvals, job postings, applicant résumés, AI screening results, and interview bookings. You do not need any technical knowledge to use it — this manual will walk you through every screen, one step at a time.

WHO THIS MANUAL IS FOR

This guide is written for everyday users: HR staff who review and set up roles, Department Heads (HODs) who request new hires, and Management who approve them. No IT background is assumed.

What does "Ella" do?

Ella is the portal's AI assistant. She can read job description documents to help draft a role request, screen résumés against the criteria HR sets up, and even conduct short phone screening interviews with candidates, recording her findings for HR to review. You will see Ella mentioned throughout the Recruitment Setup screen.

2. Signing In and Out

2.1 Signing in

1. Open your web browser and go to the Recruitment Portal web address given to you by IT/HR.
2. You will see the welcome page with the heading "**Start every hire with the right role.**"
3. Click the **Sign in with Google** button.
4. Choose your McLink Group Google account (your email must end in `@mclinkgroup.com`). If you use a personal or non-company Google account, sign-in will be refused for security reasons.
5. You will be taken automatically to your **Dashboard**.

[Screenshot: Sign-in page with the "Sign in with Google" button]

IF YOU CANNOT SIGN IN

Only people set up in the portal's User Accounts list can access it, and only with their McLink company Google account. If sign-in fails or you see an access error, contact your HR administrator to confirm your account has been created and activated (see **Section 16 — User Accounts & Permissions**).

2.2 Signing out

1. Look at the left-hand sidebar menu.
2. Under the **Account** section at the bottom, click **Sign Out**.
3. You will be returned to the public sign-in page.

TIP

Always sign out when using a shared computer, especially in an open office area.

3. Understanding the Dashboard

After signing in, you land on your **Dashboard**. This is your home screen and shows:

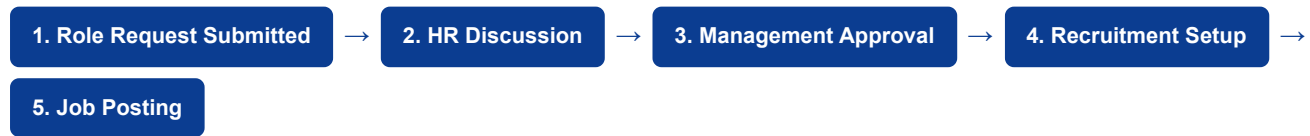
- A welcome message with your name.
- Your access level badge (what you're allowed to do — e.g. Create, Review, Approve, or Edit Settings) and your department.
- A **Create Role Request** button, if you are allowed to submit new role requests.
- Key numbers — how many role requests and applicants are currently in the pipeline.
- A **Google Calendar** card, where you can connect your own Google Calendar so scheduled interviews are added automatically (see Section 12.3).
- A step-by-step "Recruitment workflow" panel explaining the hiring stages at a glance.
- A "User access summary" panel showing exactly what your account is permitted to do.

NOTE

If your account has no recruitment permissions at all, you will see a "Limited access" message instead of the usual dashboard cards. If this happens and you believe it's a mistake, contact your HR administrator.

4. The Hiring Journey, Start to Finish (Overview)

Every new hire follows the same five-stage journey inside the portal:



You'll see this same 5-step tracker at the top of every role's detail page, so you always know exactly where a request stands. The sections below walk through each stage in detail, in order.

RULE OF THUMB

A Department Head (HOD) starts the process (Step 1). HR manages Steps 2 and 4. Management handles Step 3. HR then finishes with Step 5 (publishing) — after which candidates can apply.

5. Step 1 – Creating a Role Request

Anyone with "Create Role" permission (typically HODs) can submit a new role request.

1. From the Dashboard or the **Role Requests** menu, click **Create Role Request**.
2. You will see the Role Request form, split into two parts, described below.

[Screenshot: Role Request form — Section 1, Role request details]

5.1 Section 1 — Role Request Details

Field	What to enter
Job Description	A description of the role and its responsibilities. You can also upload an existing job description file (PDF or Word) and click Generate draft — Ella will read it and fill in the description, screening criteria, and suggested interview questions for you to review and edit.
Request Type	Choose <i>Staff Addition</i> (a brand-new position) or <i>Staff Replacement</i> (replacing someone who left).
Department	Type the department name.
Employment Type	Full-Time, Part-Time, Contract, Temporary, or Internship.
Job Title	The position's title.
Number of Vacancies	How many people you need to hire for this role (1–100).
Target Hiring Date	The date by which you'd like the position filled.
Employee/Position Being Replaced	Only appears if you chose "Staff Replacement" above.
Reason for Request	A short explanation of why this hire is needed.

5.2 Section 2 — HOD Availability & Screening

Field	What to enter
HOD / Interviewer Email	Defaults to your own email. This is the person whose calendar will receive the final interview invites.
HOD Availability Windows	Optional. Add the dates/time windows (with timezone) when you're generally free for final interviews. Click + Add availability window to add more, or Remove to delete one. This is a helpful guide for HR — exact bookable interview slots are configured later in Recruitment Setup.
Custom HOD Screening Question 1 & 2	Optional. Write up to two of your own questions you'd like Ella to ask candidates during the phone screening. Ella will generate the remaining questions automatically.

5.3 Submitting

1. Review all fields.
2. Click **Submit for HR Discussion**.

3. Your request is saved with a unique Role ID (e.g. `CSE01`) and status **Pending HR Discussion**.
4. HR is notified and will pick it up next.

EDITING LATER

You can return to **Role Requests** at any time, open your request, and click **Edit** to update it (as long as it hasn't progressed too far). The Save button only appears once you've actually changed something, so you won't accidentally save with no changes.

6. Step 2 – HR Discussion & Review

HR reviewers see all submitted role requests under **Role Requests** in the left menu. Opening a request shows its full details plus an **HR Review** action panel.

1. Open the role from the **Role Requests** list.
2. Read through the job description and requisition details. If anything required is missing (Job Description, Job Title, Department, Vacancies, Reason, or Target Date), the system will not allow the request to move forward until it's completed.
3. Type a comment explaining your decision — a comment is required for every action.
4. Choose one of the following actions:

Button	Effect
Send for Management Approval	Moves the request to Pending Management Approval .
Return for Revision by HR	Sends it back to the requester with your comments, status becomes Returned for Revision .
Place on Hold by HR	Pauses the request as On Hold until you resume it.

NOTE

Every action and comment is permanently recorded in the **Status History** timeline at the bottom of the role page, so there's always a clear audit trail of who did what and when.

7. Step 3 – Management Approval

Users with Approval permission see requests awaiting their decision. On the role page:

Button	Effect
Approve Role	Status becomes Approved , unlocking Recruitment Setup for HR.
Reject Role	Status becomes Rejected — the request stops here.
Return for Revision by Management	Sends it back with comments; status becomes Returned for Revision .
Place on Hold by Management	Status becomes On Hold until resumed.

As with HR review, a comment is required, and a "Returned for Revision" or "On Hold" request goes back to whoever should act next (HR or the requester) with a **Resume HR Review** or **Resume Management Approval** button to pick it back up.

8. Step 4 – Recruitment Setup ("AI Phone Interview Setup")

Once a role is **Approved**, HR configures how Ella will screen and phone-interview candidates for it. This section appears directly on the role's detail page, titled **"AI Phone Interview Setup"**.

8.1 Screening instructions

Tell Ella what to listen for:

- **What should Ella listen for?** (required) — the main screening criteria.
- Required license or certificate, if any.
- Keywords to look for.
- Whether transferable skills from other industries are acceptable.
- Minimum relevant experience.
- Approved salary/budget range.
- Earliest availability instructions (e.g. notice period expectations).

8.2 Evaluation fields

These are automatically included for every role: overall score, recommendation, strengths, and concerns. You can also tick additional optional fields from a ready-made list, and define up to **3 custom fields** of your own (give each a name and describe what Ella should assess). These fields are used both when Ella screens résumés and when she conducts phone interviews.

8.3 Interview questions

Ella needs at least 3 interview questions, up to 5. If the HOD supplied custom questions when submitting the role request, those appear first and are locked (shown as "from the hiring manager") — HR fills in the rest. Any AI-suggested questions from the job description upload are shown above for reference and can be reused.

8.4 Script preview

Click **"See a sample call with an example candidate"** to preview exactly how Ella's phone call will sound, using a sample candidate. Advanced users can switch to **"Advanced: edit full script"** to hand-edit the underlying script text directly — only do this if you're confident editing the wording, and make sure you don't remove the

`{{system_prompt}}` marker.

8.5 Publishing checklist

Configure how the job will be posted:

- **Posting channels** — tick LinkedIn, Facebook, and/or JobStreet.
- **Salary visibility** — Disclosed or Not disclosed.
- **License requirement** — Required, Preferred, or Not required.
- **HOD interview** — Required or Not required.

Below this, three side-by-side status cards (**Draft**, **Recruitment Ready**, **Ready for Publishing**) list anything still missing before you can move to the next stage.

8.6 Saving your progress

Button	What it does
Save	Saves your current progress as a draft. You can come back and finish later.
Mark as Recruitment Ready	Confirms the screening setup is complete.
Mark as Ready for Publishing	Confirms the posting checklist is complete.
Reset changes	Appears only when you have unsaved edits — discards them and reloads the last saved version.

CAREFUL WITH TEMPLATES

If your portal supports loading a saved template for Recruitment Setup, note that loading a template **immediately overwrites** whatever you had typed in the screening fields, with no undo. Always double-check the screening criteria and keywords after loading a template, and before publishing.

8.7 HOD Interview Availability

Just above Recruitment Setup, HR/HOD can add or remove specific interview time windows (date, start time, end time, timezone) — up to 50 windows per role. The system checks your connected Google Calendar for conflicts before adding a slot, and will warn you if a window falls on or after the Target Hiring Date, since it won't be offered to candidates as a bookable slot in that case.

9. Step 5 – Publishing the Role

1. Once the "Ready for Publishing" checklist (Section 8.5) is fully satisfied, the **Publish Role** button becomes active at the bottom of the Recruitment Setup screen.
2. Click **Publish Role**.
3. The role's status changes to **Job Posted**, and you're automatically taken back to the Role Requests list.
4. The role now appears on the public careers page for candidates to apply to.

GOOD TO KNOW

Even after publishing, you can still return to Recruitment Setup to make corrections — the screen stays editable. Only clicking Publish Role again would be blocked once it's already posted; ordinary edits and saves remain available.

10. Managing Applicants

10.1 Applicants list

Click **Applicants** in the left menu to see every candidate across all roles, or open a specific role and click its **Applicants** tab to see only that role's candidates. At the top you'll see stat tiles for total Applications, Resume Screened, Voice Interview, and Final Interview counts. You can search by name, filter by Role or Stage, choose how many rows to show per page, and select multiple applicants to bulk-delete if needed.

10.2 A candidate's profile

Click any applicant to open their full profile, which includes:

- **HR Decisions** panel — where you record your decision at each stage.
- Combined AI evidence — Ella's résumé screening findings and her phone-interview (voice screening) notes side by side.
- The uploaded résumé — viewable and downloadable.
- The interview questions asked and the candidate's recorded answers/evaluation.
- A **Final Interview** card, once the candidate reaches that stage.
- A status-tracking timeline and full history of everything that has happened with this application.

To correct a candidate's stored details, click **Edit** on their profile.

11. Manual Résumé Screening (Walk-ins, Referrals, Bulk Uploads)

Not every candidate applies through the public careers page. Use **Resume Screening** in the left menu for walk-ins, referrals, or agency candidates you want to submit directly against a published role.

11.1 Submitting one candidate

1. Go to **Resume Screening**.
2. Fill in the candidate's Name, Contact Number, and Email Address.
3. Select the Role they're applying for (only published roles are listed).
4. Upload their résumé (PDF or Word, up to 10 MB).
5. Submit — Ella will screen it against that role's criteria just like a normal application.

11.2 Bulk uploads

For larger batches, use the bulk multi-file screening panel on the same page to upload several résumés at once, or drop files into the shared Google Drive folder linked on that page (the portal checks that folder automatically every few minutes). Each file's progress is shown as Queued → Processing → Screened (or Failed/Skipped, e.g. if the same résumé was already screened for that role before).

12. Interview Bookings & Google Calendar

12.1 Bookings screen

Click **Bookings** in the left menu to see and manage all scheduled voice-screening and final interview slots across candidates.

12.2 How candidates book a slot

Candidates receive an email with a personal booking link. They pick a date and a time slot themselves — you don't need to coordinate this manually. See Section 13.3 for what they see.

12.3 Connecting your Google Calendar

1. On your Dashboard, find the **Google Calendar** card.
2. Click to connect and sign in with your Google account when prompted.
3. Once connected, any final interview assigned to you is automatically added to your own calendar, with the candidate's details included.
4. You can disconnect it from the same card at any time.

13. What Candidates See (Public Application Pages)

These pages are outside the login — candidates do not need an account.

13.1 Careers listing page

Candidates visiting the careers page see only roles that are currently **Job Posted** and fully **Published**. If nothing is currently open, they see "No published roles are currently accepting applications."

13.2 Applying to a role

Selecting a role shows the job title, department, and description, followed by an application form: Full Name, Contact Number (with a country selector), Email Address, and a résumé upload (PDF or Word, up to 10 MB). After clicking **Submit My Application**, the candidate sees a confirmation screen showing their Application ID and a message asking them to wait for an email from the recruitment team.

NOTE

Candidates currently do **not** see a live progress tracker of their application stage on the portal itself — the process ends at this confirmation screen. Any further updates (invitations to interview, etc.) are sent by email.

13.3 Booking an interview (candidate side)

When a candidate is invited to a voice screening or a final interview, they receive an emailed link. On that page they:

1. Confirm or update their mobile number.
2. Pick a date from the available date cards.
3. Pick a time slot.
4. Click **Confirm interview time**.

If they already booked, they instead see a green confirmation with their scheduled date/time. If HR marks a previous attempt as a "No Show," the page instead invites them to choose a new time. If no slots remain at all, the page asks them to reply to the invitation email directly.

14. Searching, Filtering & Managing Long Lists

Both the **Role Requests** and **Applicants** lists share the same tools:

- **Search box** — search by title, name, department, or requester.
- **Status/Stage filter** and other dropdown filters relevant to that list.
- **Sort By** — e.g. Newest, Oldest, Target Date.
- **Checkboxes** next to each row — select several and click **Delete selected** to remove multiple at once.
- **Pagination** — 25 rows per page by default (Applicants also lets you change rows-per-page).

TIP: SCROLLING ON SMALLER SCREENS

On a narrower browser window, these tables scroll sideways so the Edit/Delete buttons on the right don't get squeezed off-screen. A soft shadow appears on the edge of the table to remind you there's more to scroll to — if you see that shadow, simply scroll the table left/right (e.g. with your trackpad or the horizontal scrollbar) to reach the hidden columns and action buttons.

BEFORE YOU DELETE

Deleting a role or applicant cannot be undone. If a role has already been Approved, is in Recruitment Setup, or has been Job Posted, the portal will show an extra warning, because deleting it may also remove a live job posting. Read every delete confirmation carefully before proceeding.

15. Settings (Admin)

Available only to users with Settings permission. Click **Settings** in the left menu. Settings are grouped into categories such as **Portal Settings**, **Booking & Interview**, **Workflow Rules**, and **Notifications**. Each item shows its name, a short description, whether it's "Active" (currently used by the portal) or "Stored only" (kept for reference), and a Yes/No or text field to change it. A **System connections** panel at the top shows which integrations are configured, without exposing any sensitive login details. Make your changes, then click **Save Settings** once at the bottom to save everything at once.

16. User Accounts & Permissions (Admin)

Available only to administrators. Click **User Accounts** in the left menu to manage who can access the portal and what they're allowed to do.

16.1 Adding a new user

1. Click **Add user account**.
2. Enter their Full name, company Email, an Access role label (e.g. "HR" or "HOD" — for display only), and Department.
3. Tick the permissions that apply to them (see table below).
4. Save.

16.2 The five permissions

Permission	What it allows
Create Role	Submit new role requests and view their own submitted requests.
Review Role	Act as HR: review role requests at the HR-discussion stage, edit Recruitment Setup and HOD Availability, and make applicant stage decisions.
Approve Role	Act as Management: approve, reject, return, or hold role requests at the approval stage.
Edit Settings	Open and change the Settings screen.
Manage Users	Open and manage the User Accounts screen.

NOTE

Someone with only "Create Role" ticked can see just their own submitted requests. Anyone with "Review Role" or "Approve Role" can see all role requests in the system.

16.3 Deactivating a user

Rather than deleting an account outright (which would lose their history), click **Deactivate** next to their name — this blocks their access while keeping their past activity on record. You cannot deactivate your own account.

17. Notifications & Emails — What to Expect

The portal sends email notifications automatically at key moments. After any action (approve, reject, return, hold, publish, etc.) you'll see one of these messages confirming what happened:

Message shown	Meaning
"Update completed and notification sent."	Everything worked — the relevant person has been emailed.
"...Notification is pending."	Your action was saved; the email is still being sent (check back shortly).
"...but the notification could not be sent."	Your action was saved, but the email failed — you may want to inform the person directly.
"...but email notification is not configured."	Emails aren't set up for this type of event yet — contact your administrator.

Candidate-facing emails (invitations to book a screening call, book a final interview, or the application receipt) are sent automatically as candidates move through the process — you do not need to email candidates manually.

GOOD TO KNOW

A final-interview invitation email is currently only triggered once the AI phone screening call is marked **Completed**. If a candidate's call shows "No Answer," "Busy," or "Incomplete," approving them may not automatically send that invitation — you may need to follow up manually in that situation.

18. Troubleshooting & Frequently Asked Questions

I clicked Sign Out and nothing happened.

This has been fixed as of 17 August 2026. If you're still seeing this, refresh the page and try again, or clear your browser cache.

I can't find the Edit/Delete buttons on the Role Requests or Applicants table.

On smaller browser windows the table scrolls sideways. Look for a soft shadow on the right edge of the table and scroll right to reveal the Action column.

The Recruitment Setup or HOD Availability sections look locked/read-only.

Check that the role's status is Approved, Recruitment Setup, or Job Posted — these sections only unlock at that stage — and that your account has the "Review Role" permission.

The country flag/dial code selector looks broken.

This was a display bug that has been fixed. If it still looks wrong, try refreshing your browser or clearing its cache.

I can't click Publish Role.

Check the "Ready for Publishing" checklist card on the Recruitment Setup screen — every item listed there must be completed first.

A candidate says they never got a confirmation email.

Check the notification message shown after their last status change (see Section 17). If it says the notification failed or wasn't sent, contact them directly and inform your administrator.

Can candidates track their own application status online?

Not currently — candidates only see a submission receipt after applying. Status updates are communicated by email instead.

I loaded a Recruitment Setup template and now my screening fields look different.

Loading a template overwrites your current screening fields immediately. Always review the screening criteria, keywords, and questions afterward before saving or publishing.

19. Quick Reference — Status Glossary

Status	Meaning
Pending HR Discussion	Newly submitted, waiting for HR to review.
Pending Management Approval	HR has forwarded it; waiting for Management's decision.
Approved	Management approved it; Recruitment Setup is now unlocked.
Rejected	Management declined the request. Process ends here.
Returned for Revision	Sent back to the previous step with comments for changes.
On Hold	Paused; can be resumed by whoever placed it on hold.
Job Posted	The role has been published and is visible to candidates.

Recruitment Setup sub-status

Sub-status	Meaning
Draft	Setup started but not yet complete.
Recruitment Ready	Screening setup (criteria, questions, evaluation fields) is complete.
Ready for Publishing	Posting checklist is complete; ready to click Publish Role.
Published	The job is live and visible to candidates on the careers page.

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